Behaviour Policy

Teaching Positive Behaviour and Emotional Regulation

Aligned with EYFS Framework, Dubai Inclusive Education Policy Framework, and KHDA Guidelines

Policy Number: WWN/BHV/2025

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Date of Review: 01 September 2027

Responsible Person: Behaviour and Wellbeing Lead (Centre Manager/Senior Leadership Team)

1. Policy Rationale

At Wonder Whiz Kids Nursery, we believe that behaviour is learned and that teaching positive behaviour and emotional regulation is central to early childhood education. Young children are developing their social and emotional identities, and it is our role to guide them in a warm, respectful, and consistent way.

This policy outlines our approach to teaching behaviour and attitudes through the EYFS Personal, Social and Emotional Development (PSED) area, and through embedded, trauma-informed, and emotionally responsive strategies.

2. Policy Aims

- To build a safe, respectful, and inclusive nursery culture where all children feel secure, heard, and valued.

- To teach children how to express themselves positively, regulate emotions, solve problems, and make good choices.
- To support children with consistent expectations, guidance, and modelling.
- To equip staff with tools and knowledge to manage behaviour using a trauma-informed and developmentally appropriate approach.
- To work in partnership with families, therapists, and other professionals when needed.

3. Behaviour as a Curriculum Area

We view behaviour not as a disciplinary issue but as a developmental process to be taught, modelled, and practised. Our approach includes:

- Emotion Coaching: Teaching children to recognise, name, and manage emotions.
- Circle Time and Stories: Used to explore themes like kindness, taking turns, respecting differences, and solving problems.
- Role Play and Social Scenarios: Children practise conflict resolution, empathy, and cooperation.
- Visual Supports and Social Stories: Aid in understanding routines, expectations, and transitions.
- Routine, Predictability, and Rhythm: Support security and reduce anxiety-driven behaviours.

This aligns with the EYFS area of Personal, Social and Emotional Development (PSED) and promotes character-building, emotional literacy, and resilience.

4. Core Behaviour Expectations

We set clear, age-appropriate expectations that are consistent across all areas and adults:

- Be Kind: Use gentle hands and respectful words.
- Be Safe: Use furniture and equipment safely; follow directions.
- Be a Learner: Try new things; listen; use your words; keep trying.
- Be Responsible: Take care of belongings, spaces, and others.

These are taught explicitly, reinforced through visual reminders, and supported through consistent adult modelling.

5. Emotionally Responsive and Trauma-Informed Practice

All staff are trained in responding to children with empathy and understanding, particularly those with trauma, sensory needs, or social communication difficulties.

Key Elements:

- Connection before Correction: Staff connect emotionally before addressing the behaviour.
- Calm-Down Corners and Regulation Tools: Each room has safe spaces where children can take a break or use sensory tools.
- Co-Regulation Strategies: Adults help children regulate before expecting self-regulation.
- Reflective Language: "I see you're upset. Let's find a way to calm down." vs. "Stop crying."
- Respectful Guidance: Adults avoid shaming, sarcasm, or punitive tones.

We recognise that behaviour is communication and respond to the needs behind the behaviour rather than the behaviour alone.

6. Supporting Children of Determination

Children with identified or emerging SEND may:

- Exhibit behaviours due to communication barriers, sensory sensitivities, or social challenges.
- Require additional support such as 1:1 teaching, sensory regulation plans, or external therapy.

For these children:

- Behaviour Support Plans (BSPs) are developed in collaboration with families and specialists.

- Interventions are personalised and monitored by the Inclusion Support Coordinator (ISCO).
- Progress is reviewed bi-monthly and integrated with IEP goals.

We maintain high but flexible expectations, always honouring the child's dignity and developmental stage.

7. Managing Challenging Behaviour

Our approach is always restorative and instructional. When misbehaviour occurs:

1. Private Redirection – The child is reminded of the expected behaviour using calm language.
2. Co-regulation – If the child is dysregulated, they are supported in calming down before discussing the behaviour.
3. Natural Consequences – If appropriate, a natural and relevant consequence follows (e.g., helping clean up a spill).
4. Restorative Practice – When ready, the child is supported to repair the harm (apology, helping a peer, drawing a peace picture).
5. Documentation – Incidents are logged, and parents are informed sensitively for partnership and consistency.

We never use time-out, threats, or withdrawal of love or safety as punishment.

8. Teaching Staff's Role

Staff are expected to:

- Be calm, emotionally available adults (secure base).
- Model respectful, inclusive language at all times.
- Use praise and encouragement to reinforce positive behaviour.
- Scaffold social problem-solving and peer negotiation.
- Maintain consistent, predictable routines.
- Maintain high expectations with flexible understanding.

They receive regular training in:

- Emotion Coaching
- Trauma-Informed Practice
- Behaviour Observation and Intervention
- Inclusion and SEND Support

9. Family Partnership

We understand that consistency between home and nursery is essential. We:

- Discuss behaviour approaches during admission and transition meetings.
- Communicate positively and openly with families about concerns and progress.
- Offer guidance on behaviour strategies at home when needed.
- Involve families in BSP/IEP development where applicable.

10. Monitoring and Evaluation

- The Behaviour and Wellbeing Lead, together with the ISCO and SLT, monitors behaviour trends and responses through observations and staff feedback.
- Challenging behaviour incidents are tracked to identify patterns and inform training or interventions.
- The effectiveness of strategies is reviewed termly.
- The policy is reviewed annually or earlier if required by changes in legislation or nursery needs.

11. Linked Policies

This policy works in alignment with:

- Inclusive Education Policy
- Curriculum and Learning Policy
- Safeguarding and Wellbeing Policy
- Teaching, Learning, and Assessment Policy
- Health and Safety Policy

12. Glossary

- Emotion Coaching: Teaching children to understand and regulate emotions.
- Co-regulation: Adult helps child calm down before self-regulation is possible.
- BSP: Behaviour Support Plan – strategy document for children with ongoing behaviour challenges.
- Trauma-Informed Practice: Recognising the impact of trauma on development and behaviour and responding with compassion and structure.